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Computer peripheral device

Abstract

A computer peripheral device is provided. The computer peripheral device is adapted to be installed in an electronic device supporting signal transmission of a first signal frequency. The computer peripheral device includes a human interface device (HID) and a bridging device. The HID includes a control unit to support signal transmission of a second signal frequency. The bridging device includes a first universal serial bus (USB) interface unit and a second USB interface unit. The first USB interface unit is adapted to be electrically connected to the electronic device, and supports signal transmission of the first signal frequency. The second USB interface unit is adapted to be electrically connected to the HID. The second USB interface unit regards the HID as a communication device class (CDC) device, instructs the control unit to generate an input signal at a timing corresponding to the first signal frequency, and transmits the input signal to the electronic device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims the priority benefit of Taiwan application serial No. 112124835, filed on Jul. 4, 2023. The entirety of the above-mentioned patent application is hereby incorporated by

reference herein and made a part of the specification.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(2) The disclosure relates to a computer peripheral device, and in particular, to a computer peripheral device applicable to a universal serial bus (USB) protocol.

Description of the Related Art

(3) A conventional USB human interface device, such as a keyboard or a mouse, is usually matched with a microcontroller unit supporting low speed signal transmission to reduce costs.

(4) In this case, even if a USB interface on a computer host supports high speed signal transmission, the USB interface is limited by the HID and only performs signal transmission at a low speed, failing to effectively take advantage of the high speed signal transmission.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) The disclosure provides a computer peripheral device, adapted to be installed in an electronic device. The electronic device supports signal transmission of a first signal frequency according to a USB protocol. The computer peripheral device includes an HID and a bridging device. The HID includes a control unit, and the control unit supports signal transmission of a second signal frequency according to the USB protocol.

(6) The bridging device includes a first USB interface unit and a second USB interface unit. The first USB interface unit is adapted to be electrically connected to the electronic device. The first USB interface unit supports signal transmission of the first signal frequency according to the USB protocol. The second USB interface unit is adapted to be electrically connected to the HID. The second USB interface unit regards the HID as a communication device class (CDC) device, instructs the control unit to generate an input signal at a timing corresponding to the first signal frequency, and transmits the received input signal to the electronic device through the first USB interface unit.

(7) The computer peripheral device provided in the disclosure includes the bridging device as the bridge between the HID and the electronic device. The bridging device regards the HID in the disclosure as a CDC device defined by the USB protocol, rather than an HID class device. In this way, the HID generates the input signal at the timing corresponding to the first signal frequency.

(8) Because both the bridging device and the electronic device support the higher first signal frequency, the input signal is smoothly transmitted to the electronic device through the first USB interface unit. In this way, the HID communicates with the electronic device at the higher first signal frequency without being limited by the fact that the HID only supports the lower second signal frequency.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The sole FIGURE is a schematic block diagram of a computer peripheral device according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(2) The following describes specific implementations of the disclosure in more detail with reference to the drawings. According to the following description and scope of patent application, advantages and characteristics of the disclosure are clearer. It is to be noted that, the drawings adopt a very simplified form and use a non-precise proportion, and are only used for conveniently and clearly illustrating the embodiments of the disclosure.

(3) The sole FIGURE is a schematic block diagram of a computer peripheral device **100** according to an embodiment of the disclosure. The computer peripheral device **100** is adapted to be installed in an electronic device **200**, such as a computer host, a notebook computer, or other electronic

devices that support a USB protocol and is used as a host under the USB protocol. According to the definition of the USB protocol, the electronic device **200** supports signal transmission of a first signal frequency at most. In an embodiment, the first signal frequency corresponds to USB high speed signal transmission.

(4) As shown in the FIGURE, the computer peripheral device **100** includes an HID **120** and a bridging device **140**.

(5) The HID **120** includes a control unit **122**. According to the definition of the USB protocol, the control unit **122** supports signal transmission of a second signal frequency at most for HID class devices. In an embodiment, the HID **120** is a mouse. In an embodiment, the second signal frequency corresponds to USB full speed (FS) mode signal transmission with the upper limit of 1 kHz. The first signal frequency is higher than the second signal frequency. For the definition of the USB high speed (HS) mode signal transmission, the frequency reaches 8 KHz.

(6) The bridging device **140** includes a first port **142**, a second port **144**, a first USB interface unit **146**, and a second USB interface unit **148**. The first port **142** is adapted to be connected to the electronic device **200**, and the second port **144** is adapted to be connected to the HID **120**. The first USB interface unit **146** is electrically connected to the electronic device **200** through the first port **142**. The second USB interface unit **148** is electrically connected to the HID **120** through the second port **144**.

(7) In an embodiment, as shown in the FIGURE, the first USB interface unit **146** and the second USB interface unit **148** are integrated in an MCU **149** to reduce the manufacturing cost and reduce the size of the bridging device **140**. In another embodiment, the bridging device **140** is a wireless dongle.

(8) The first USB interface unit **146** is a device interface unit adapted to be electrically connected to the electronic device **200**. According to the definition of the USB protocol, the first USB interface unit **146** supports signal transmission of the first signal frequency at most.

(9) The second USB interface unit **148** is a host interface unit adapted to be electrically connected to the HID **120**. According to the definition of the USB protocol, the second USB interface unit **148** supports the signal transmission of the second signal frequency at most for HID class devices.

(10) When the first port **142** is plugged into the electronic device **200** and the HID **120** is plugged into the second port **144**, the second USB interface unit **148** regards the HID **120** as a communication device class (CDC) device defined by the USB protocol, and instructs the control unit **122** to transmit an input signal **S1_B** at the first signal frequency in a bulk transfer manner.

(11) Specifically, the control unit **122** controls a transmission timing in bulk transfer to simulate the input signal **S1_B** of the first signal frequency, that is, generates the input signal **S1_B** at a timing corresponding to the first signal frequency. For example, when the first signal frequency is 8 kHz, the control unit **122** controls the transmission timing in bulk transfer to 125 microseconds to simulate the input signal **S1_B** of 8 kHz.

(12) After receiving the input signal **S1_B**, the second USB interface unit **148** transmits an input signal **S1_I** to the electronic device **200** through the first USB interface unit **146** at a transmission speed of the first signal frequency.

(13) It is worth noting that in this architecture, a transmission interface between the second USB interface unit **148** and the control unit **122** is based on a transmission manner corresponding to the CDC device defined by the USB protocol, that is, a bulk transfer manner, for data transmission. This transmission manner supports high signal frequencies. A transmission interface between the first USB interface unit **146** and the electronic device **200** is based on a transmission manner corresponding to the HID **120** defined by the USB protocol, that is, an interrupt transfer manner, for data transmission.

(14) In this specification, the input signal **S1_B** transmitted from the control unit **122** to the second USB interface unit **148** and the input signal **S1_I** transmitted from the first USB interface unit **146** to the electronic device **200** are represented with different symbols to illustrate that although the

two input signals **S1_B** and **S1_I** have the same signal frequency for data transmission, they are generated in different signal transmission manners.

(15) In an embodiment, the control unit **122** is preset to perform signal transmission at the second signal frequency in an interrupt transfer manner. In this way, when the HID **120** is directly plugged into the electronic device **200**, a USB control chip (not shown in the drawing) in the electronic device **200** communicates with the HID **120** in the interrupt transfer manner based on the second signal frequency supported by the control unit **122** in the HID **120**.

(16) On the contrary, when the HID **120** is connected to the electronic device **200** through the bridging device **140**, and the interface transmission signal frequency supported by the electronic device **200** is higher than the second signal frequency, such as supporting the first signal frequency, the second USB interface unit **148** regards the HID **120** as a CDC device, so that it transmits the input signal **S1_B** at the first signal frequency in the bulk transfer manner.

(17) In this way, data transmission is performed between the HID **120** and the electronic device **200** at the transmission speed of the first signal frequency, instead of being limited to the HID **120**, to perform the signal transmission only at the second signal frequency.

(18) The computer peripheral device **100** provided in the disclosure includes the bridging device **140** as the bridge between the HID **120** and the electronic device **200**. The bridging device **140** regards the HID **120** in the disclosure as a CDC device defined by the USB protocol rather than an HID class device. In this way, the HID **120** generates the input signal **S1_B** at the timing corresponding to the first signal frequency.

(19) Because both the bridging device **140** and the electronic device **200** support the first signal frequency, the input signals **S1_B** and **S1_I** are smoothly transmitted to the electronic device **200** through the first USB interface unit **146**. In this way, the HID **120** communicates with the electronic device **200** at the higher first signal frequency without being limited by the fact that the HID **120** only supports the lower second signal frequency.

(20) The above is only an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure, and does not limit the disclosure. Variations such as equivalent replacements or modifications in any form made by any person skilled in the art to the technical means and technical contents disclosed in the disclosure without departing from the technical means of the disclosure are contents not departing from the technical means of the disclosure and still fall within the protection scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A computer peripheral device, adapted to be installed in an electronic device, wherein the electronic device supports signal transmission of a first signal frequency according to a universal serial bus (USB) protocol, and the computer peripheral device comprises: a human interface device (HID) class device, comprising a control unit, wherein the control unit supports signal transmission of a second signal frequency according to the USB protocol; and a bridging device, comprising: a first USB interface unit, adapted to be electrically connected to the electronic device, wherein the first USB interface unit supports signal transmission of the first signal frequency according to the USB protocol; and a second USB interface unit, adapted to be electrically connected to the HID class device, wherein when the HID class device is electrically connected to the bridge device, the second USB interface unit regards the HID class device as a communication device class (CDC) device, instructs the control unit to generate an input signal at a timing corresponding to the first signal frequency, and transmits the received input signal to the electronic device through the first USB interface unit.

2. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the second signal frequency corresponds to USB full speed mode signal transmission, and the first signal frequency corresponds to USB high speed mode signal transmission.

3. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the first signal frequency is higher

than the second signal frequency.

4. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the control unit transmits the input signal at the first signal frequency in a bulk transfer manner.
 5. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the HID class device is a mouse.
 6. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the control unit is preset to perform signal transmission at the second signal frequency in an interrupt transfer manner.
 7. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the first USB interface unit is a device interface unit, and the second USB interface unit is a host interface unit.
 8. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the bridging device comprises a first port and a second port, the first USB interface unit is electrically connected to the electronic device through the first port, and the second USB interface unit is electrically connected to the HID class device through the second port.
 9. The computer peripheral device according to claim 1, wherein the first USB interface unit and the second USB interface unit are integrated in a microcontroller unit (MCU).
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